

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Matrimonial/Family Legal Assistant role at Davies and Partners because my experience managing case files, drafting correspondence and advising clients on procedural requirements directly maps to what this role involves, and family law is a practice area I have encountered first-hand through my work at Citizens Advice.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I advise clients across family, housing, employment and welfare matters. A significant part of the family-related work involves taking detailed factual statements from clients in difficult personal circumstances, establishing chronologies, identifying the relevant legal issues and translating complex procedural rules into guidance people can actually act on. I manage those matters from the initial interview through to submission: drafting correspondence, preparing document schedules and maintaining confidential case records to deadlines. That work has required me to handle sensitive information carefully and communicate clearly with clients who are often distressed, which I see as directly relevant to client-facing family law work.

Before that, my placement year at BCLP gave me grounding in the practical mechanics of running legal matters. In the Real Estate Disputes team I prepared electronic bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, tracked deadlines across several concurrent matters and maintained matter records on iManage. In the International Arbitration team I coordinated documents and outstanding actions under time pressure as the only junior supporting the team before a significant submission deadline. Both rotations required the kind of file organisation and deadline management that a busy family law practice depends on.

I am applying to Davies and Partners specifically because the role is described as varied, and my background spans disputes, client advice and document-heavy procedural work rather than a single narrow area. A firm that handles both business and individual clients, and runs offices across multiple locations, is somewhere I expect the work to stay substantive rather than narrow. My Citizens Advice experience has made me want to do more in areas that directly affect individuals in difficult circumstances, and a permanent family law role is a clear next step from that.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva